

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex commercial litigation and arbitration at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, alongside case preparation and client advisory work at Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in reviewing and organising evidence, preparing hearing bundles, drafting procedural documents, managing case files across competing deadlines, and communicating with clients on sensitive matters. Strong legal research skills and a solid foundation in dispute resolution procedure, developed through both practice and an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration from evidence review through to filing of the Claimant's memorial: reviewed and organised documentary evidence, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across several concurrent matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines; maintained matter records in iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified compliance risks from the client's data processing
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review; electronic bundling; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review and organisation; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; case-file management; deadline tracking across concurrent matters